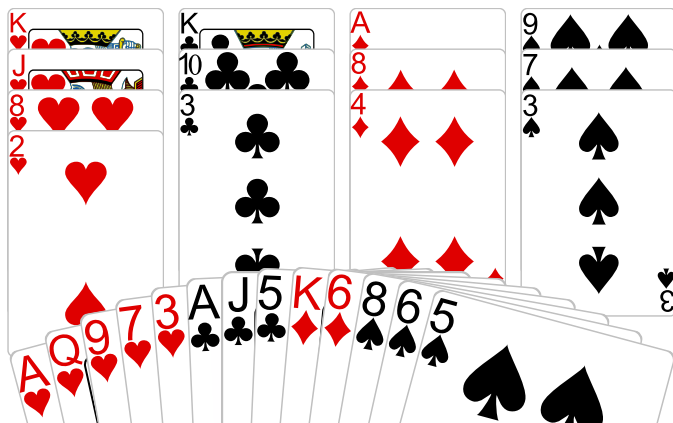
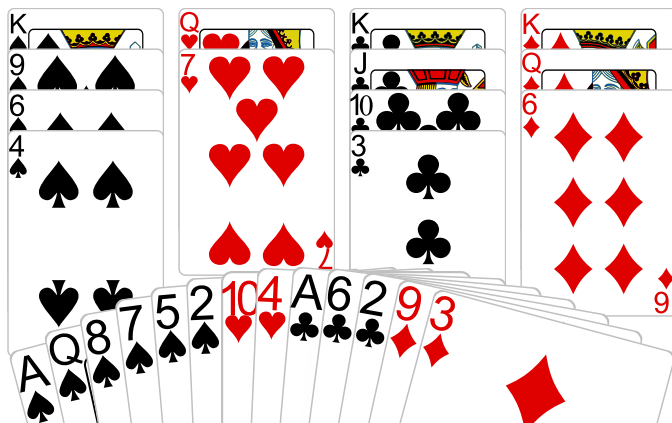


Deal 2 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q 10 2
 ♥ 6 4
 ♦ Q 7 5
 ♣ 9 8 6 2

♠ 8 6 5
 ♥ A Q 9 7 3
 ♦ K 6
 ♣ A J 5



♠ K J 4
 ♥ 10 5
 ♦ J 10 9 3 2
 ♣ Q 7 4

♠ 9 7 3
 ♥ K J 8 2
 ♦ A 8 4
 ♣ K 10 3

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by North

Using elimination plays makes you a better player. But in Bridge, no matter how skillful you are, there will always be a luck factor.

Here you were lucky the defense didn't start by taking their three ♠s. If they had, you would not have been able to pull off the throw-in, and would have had to try your luck with guessing who had the ♣Q.

North is to play 4♥. East leads the ♦J.

With three unavoidable ♠ losers you cannot afford to lose a ♣. So you either have to guess the location of the ♣Q or (DRUMROLL) pull off an elimination play! Win the ♦K, then pull trumps, it takes two rounds.

Next you eliminate the ♦s by playing ♦A then ruffing the ♦8.

Execute the throw-in by leading a ♠.

The defense is in with a ♠ and they are welcome to take two more ♠s. But then they will have to play a ♠ or a ♦, giving you a ruff-sluff, or else lead a ♣ which finds the ♣Q for you.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 9 6 4

♥ Q 7

♦ K Q 6

♣ K J 10 3

♠ 10

♥ K J 8 3 2

♦ A 5 4 2

♣ 9 7 4



♠ A Q 8 7 5 2

♥ 10 4

♦ 9 3

♣ A 6 2

♠ J 3

♥ A 9 6 5

♦ J 10 8 7

♣ Q 8 5

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

If North is the one who has to play a ♣ you just let it ride around to dummy's ♣ K J 10 3.

If South is the one who has to play a ♣ you need to insert the ♣10 or ♣J from dummy.

In either case you will no longer have a ♣ loser.

East is to play 4 ♠. South leads the ♦ J, covered by the ♦ Q and ♦ A. North returns a ♦ to the ♦ K.

You still have two losers in the ♥ suit, so the question is which way you plan to finesse the ♣s. And of course the answer is that you don't plan to finesse them at all!

Pull trumps with the ♠ A, then ♠ K. Next ruff dummy's last ♦.

Now exit with a ♥. The defenders win this and take another ♥ trick, leaving this position.

They must now break the ♣ suit for you or give you a ruff-sluff. Of course you would ruff in dummy and discard a ♣ from the 3-card holding in your hand.